SMART INDIA HACKATHON 2026

Problem Statement ID - 26231

Problem Statement Title -Digital Companion for Field Drug Testing

Theme - MedTech / BioTech / HealthTech

PS Category - Software

Team ID - K26234

Team Name - HexTech

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PROPOSED SOLUTION

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Problem

India: 1,20,010 NDPS cases in 2023 (source: NCRB, Crime in India 2023)

- Officers mainly judge the kit's colour change by looking at it, so lighting and personal judgement can affect the result.
- There is no standard colour value to compare the test result with.
- The test does not always leave a clear digital record of who performed it, where, and when, making it harder to verify later.

Solution

- Check the Test - The mobile app captures the colour change and helps check the result.
- Record the Test - Saves the result along with the time, location, and Inspector ID.
- Manage the Records - The admin dashboard manages Inspectors, test records, evidence, and reports.

User Experience

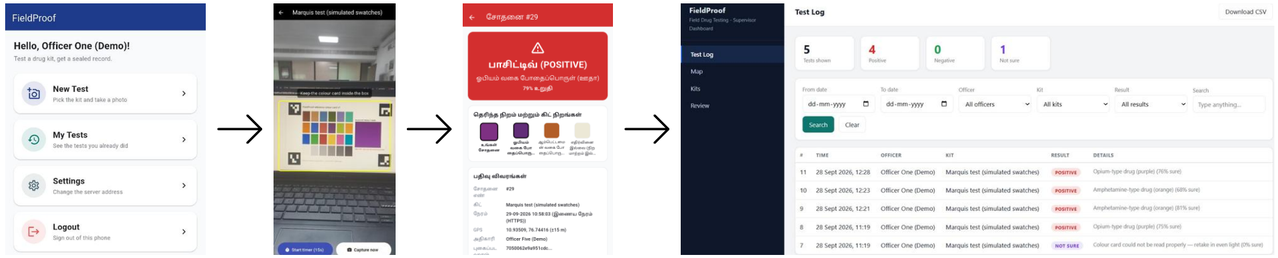
- **4 steps** - choose kit, take photo inside the box, see result, it gets saved. One test takes around 16 seconds (we checked in 19 scans).
- **Bad photo?** - app says NOT SURE, tells the reason (blurry, shiny or card not seen) and asks to take the photo again.
- **Easy to read** - Result is shown in big coloured letters, so anyone can read it easily. Works in Tamil too.

Prototype Demo Video: Prototype Video Link

Our Approach

Test Kit → Take Photo → Check Colour → Get Result → Save Proof → Admin Review

Prototype Flow - real screenshots of our working prototype



Result screen shown in Tamil. Test Log (right) can search and filter by date, officer, kit and result, and download CSV or PDF with QR.

Novelty

Eye check is guesswork, lab is slow, **FieldProof gives result on the spot for ₹10 with proof**

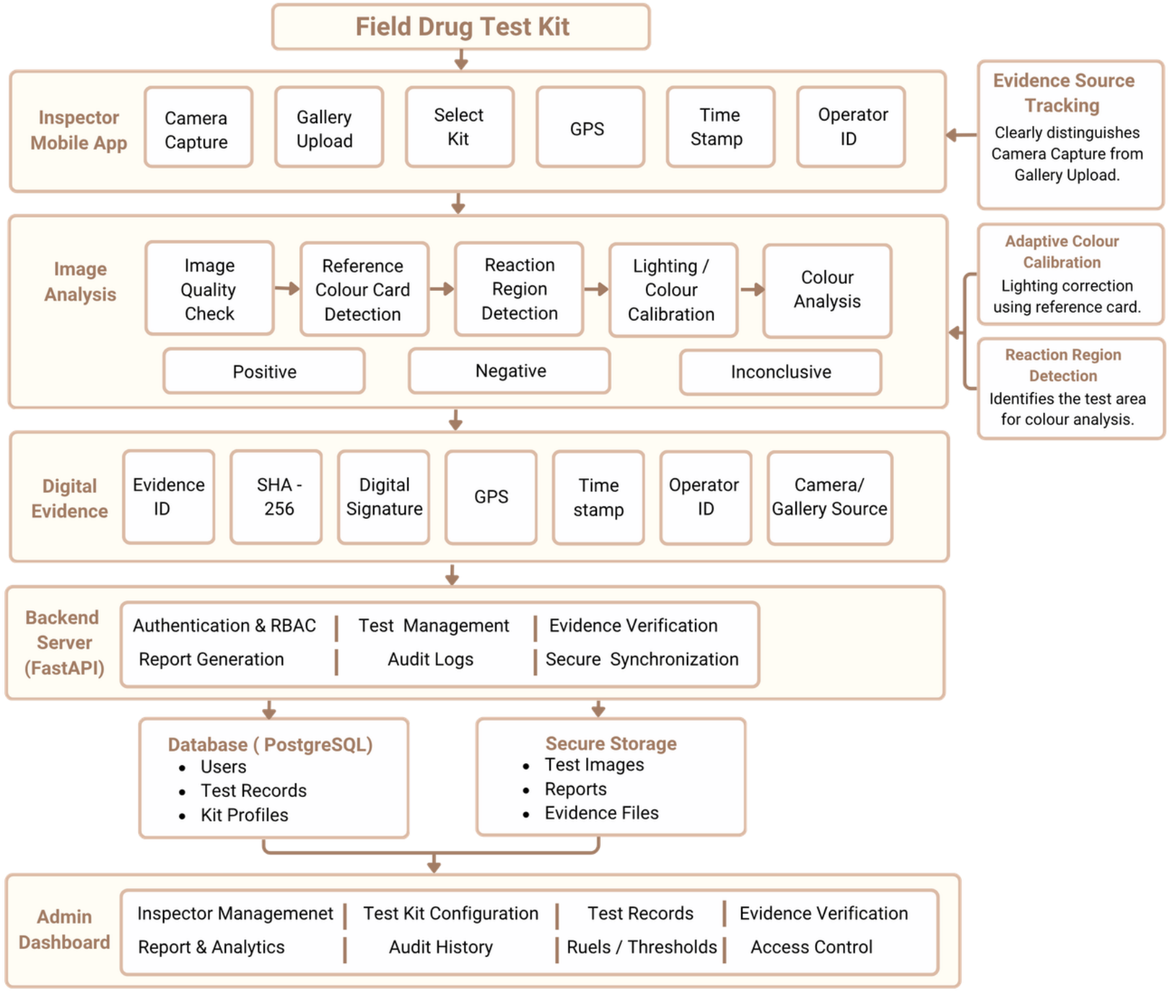
- **Handles Lighting Variations** - Uses a low-cost colour card to improve colour detection under different lighting.
- **Handles Unclear Results** - Blurry, shiny, or unclear images are marked INCONCLUSIVE instead of giving a wrong result.
- **Creates Verifiable Evidence** - Securely records the photo, GPS, time, and Inspector ID, with QR-based verification.
- **Supports Multiple Kits** - New kit colour profiles can be added from the Admin website without changing the app.

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TECHNICAL APPROACH

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System Architecture

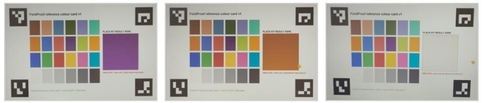


Our Goals - Measured Results

- Testing: 37 computer made photos and 25 real phone scans.
- Accuracy: all 25 computer made photos correct. Real scans had 0 wrong answers (14 correct, others said NOT SURE).
- Colour Check: Used ΔE ≤ 14, 4-point colour matching, card-fit and glare thresholds.
- Speed: Result secured in 2.5 s typically, 5 s maximum.
- Tamper Test: All 4/4 modified records were detected successfully.

Kit colours are simulated swatches (test photos + card on a screen), real kits need an FSL calibration trial.
Right now it is a lab prototype (TRL 4) tested on 1 phone. Next we test real kits with FSL on more phones.

Proof from Real Phone Scans (29 Sep 2026)



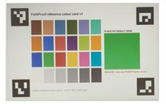
Purple card
POSITIVE 79%

Orange card
POSITIVE 76%

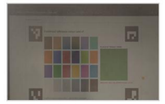
Plain card
NEGATIVE 75%



In-between card
NOT SURE



Green card (not in kit)
NOT SURE



Blurry photo
NOT SURE, retake

We scanned using our app on 1 phone, in 1 room with window light. Card was shown on a laptop screen. We checked each card by eye, not using the app.

Colour gap (Delta E), our limit is 14
Right colour: 4.7 to 8.9
Other kit colours: 34 to 42
Trick cards: 16 to 31, so app said NOT SURE

All 19 real scans

Card vs app	POSITIVE	NEGATIVE	NOT SURE
Positive card (8)	5	0	3
Plain card (4)	0	4	0
Trick card (7)	0	0	7

0 wrong answers

All 9 clear scans correct
All 7 trick cards said NOT SURE
3 blurry photos, app asked to retake
Around 16 seconds per test (1 team member)

Technology Stack

- Flutter (Dart)
- FastAPI (Python)
- OpenCV + NumPy
- CIELAB + ΔE2000
- PostgreSQL + SQLAlchemy
- React + Vite
- JWT + bcrypt
- SHA-256
- Ed25519
- NTP
- Leaflet + OpenStreetMap
- ReportLab

Offline Design

No network? The phone keeps the photo and its hash in a queue.
Network back: it sends them in the background.
Server checks the hash, then seals the record.
(design ready, we build it next)

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FEASIBILITY AND VIABILITY

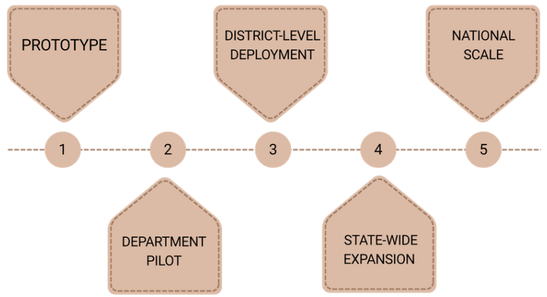
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Feasibility & Sustainability

Legal: the app gives a first check only, the FSL lab confirms it.
Privacy: no face or suspect name is stored, only a sample code.

- **Technical** - Core app tested with OpenCV-based colour analysis.
- **User-Friendly** - Capture one photo and get a result within seconds.
- **Low Cost** - Uses an existing Android phone, a reusable ~₹10 colour card, and open-source tools.
- **Operational** - Simple photo-based workflow with minimal training required.
- **Scalable** - Add new test-kit colour profiles through the Admin website without updating the app.
- **Sustainable** - Government-cloud hosting, regular profile updates, and secure data storage support long-term use.

Phased Implementation & Scalability



Pilot Plan (proposed)

- **Where** - 1 district in Tamil Nadu, with local police and the nearest FSL
- **Who** - 20 officers, for 3 months
- **Check** - every field result is checked again in the FSL lab
- **Success** - 95% or more same as lab, NOT SURE below 10%, every record passes the check
- **Cost** - 20 cards at ₹10 = ₹200, server ₹3,000 a month for 3 months = ₹9,000. Total about ₹9,200 (estimate)

Potential Challenges & Strategies

Real-world problem	What our app does
Bad light (street lamp / torch)	Colour card fixes the colours
Shiny or blurry photo, card missing	Says NOT SURE and asks to retake
Colour is in between two results	Says NOT SURE; senior officer checks
Fake photo or edited record	In-app camera only + photo fingerprint
Different kits and phones	Kit settings + colours fixed every photo

Scale (estimate): India had 1,20,010 NDPS cases in 2023 (NCRB), about 330 a day.
Our colour check takes 0.12 s per photo, so one small server can check thousands of photos an hour. Each photo is about 0.85 MB, so all of India needs about 100 GB a year.

Cost & Deployment Plan

After the pilot: police or NCB IT budget, server about ₹36,000 a year (estimate).
Owner: state police IT cell runs the app, the FSL keeps kit colours correct.
Upkeep: security update every 3 months. MoU with police and FSL is planned.

COST	HOSTING	MAINTENANCE	DEPLOYMENT	SCALE
Uses an existing phone, ₹10 reusable colour card, and open-source software.	Runs on government cloud for the app, database, and admin dashboard.	Regular security updates and easy kit-profile updates as needed.	Start with a pilot, test in the field, then expand deployment.	New test kits can be added through the website without updating the app.

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IMPACT AND BENEFITS

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Inspector Benefits

- Faster, more consistent testing
- Less manual colour checking
- INCONCLUSIVE when unclear
- Easy digital test records
- Quick access to past test records

Organisation Benefits

- Proof of every test: time, place, officer & photo
- Secure and verifiable records
- Less paperwork with PDF & QR
- Easy search, reports and monitoring
- Better field-test documentation

QR-Based Record Verification

FieldProof - Field Test Record

Presumptive field result — not a substitute for laboratory confirmatory testing.

POSITIVE
Opium-type drug (purple) | 76% sure



Scan to check this record
http://127.0.0.1:8000/v/11

Test number	11
Test ID	4878cf1d-8f00-4f66-9f73-30c50ed39e62
Saved at (UTC)	2026-09-28T06:58:23.601Z (time from: internet time (HTTPS))
Phone time	2026-09-28T12:28:21+05:30 (difference: -2.6 s)
GPS location	10.935299, 76.743282 (±14.791999816894531 m)
Officer	Officer One (Demo) (user id 1)
Device ID	android-1e42a9c170701656ac8a22b0ca44a6e0
Kit	Marquis test (simulated swatches) [DEMO-MARQUIS-SIM], profile version 1
Lab sample ID	-
Review status	NOT_NEEDED

FieldProof · Record check

✓ Record is genuine
The photo and details were not changed after they were saved.

What we checked

- ✓ The photo is the same as when it was taken
- ✓ The saved details match their fingerprint (hash)
- ✓ The FieldProof server's digital signature is valid
- ✓ The record is correctly linked to the record before it
- ✓ The result, officer and kit shown are the ones that were signed

Record details

Test number	11
Result	POSITIVE
What the kit showed	Opium-type drug (purple)
How sure	76%
Kit	Marquis test (simulated swatches) (version 1)
Officer	Officer One (Demo)
Saved at (UTC)	2026-09-28T06:58:23.601Z (internet time (HTTPS))
GPS	10.93530, 76.74328
Test ID	4878cf1d-8f00-4f66-9f73-30c50ed39e62
Photo fingerprint (SHA-256)	294b35454c7e963c7e0f939b4f0e9cd10a279e69fca62634d61ea030d98a9e57

Map - Geo-Tagged test result



Tamper Test - the photo hash is signed inside each record

Test #10
prev 2ece5c80
hash 6b1b4e7f

→ **Test #11**
prev 6b1b4e7f
hash 03dd9f0c

→ **Test #12**
prev 03dd9f0c
hash a110cff6

Ed25519 signature of test 11
JRIdu6ERgadC+2n6chKfUStp...
Photo SHA-256 (signed in record)
294b35454c7e963c7e0f939b...

What we changed (test #11)	Check page	Failed check
Nothing (original)	GENUINE	none, all 5 passed
1 byte of the photo	TAMPERED	photo
Result inside sealed copy	TAMPERED	hash, signature, fields
Result in database row	TAMPERED	fields
The signature	TAMPERED	signature

We tried this on our real saved records on 29 Sep 2026, only in memory. Each test keeps the hash of the test before it.

Future Scope (our plan after SIH)

- Offline Mode (month 1) - build the offline design shown on slide 3.
- Phone Security (month 2) - sign each test with the phone's security chip.
- Police System Integration - match our fields to e-Sakshya, get NIC or MHA approval, then send each sealed record with its photo hash.
- Lab Comparison (during pilot) - compare field results with FSL lab results.
- Regional Languages - Tamil is done in the app. Hindi and voice help in month 3.

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RESEARCH AND REFERENCES

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What they found	How we use it	Research
IEEE EMBC 2016 Phone camera colours change with light and phone model; reference colours can help handle this.	Our ₹10 colour card fixes colours in every test	[1] H. Karisen and T. Dong, "Illumination and device independence for colorimetric detection of urinary biomarkers with smartphone," in Proc. 38th Annu. Int. Conf. IEEE Eng. Med. Biol. Soc. (EMBC), Orlando, FL, USA, 2016, pp. 5184-5187, doi: 10.1109/EMBC.2016.7591895.
IEEE TPS-ISA 2024 Digital evidence must maintain integrity and show how it was handled.	Photo fingerprint + signature + chained log	[2] S. Nath, K. Summers, J. Baek, and G.-J. Ahn, "Digital evidence chain of custody: Navigating new realities of digital forensics," in Proc. IEEE 6th Int. Conf. Trust, Privacy Secur. Intell. Syst. Appl. (TPS-ISA), Washington, DC, USA, 2024, pp. 11-20, doi: 10.1109/TPS-ISA62245.2024.00012.
Forensic Science International 2014 A mobile phone camera can measure drug-test colours using RGB values.	Our app reads the test colour as a number	[3] A. Choodum, K. Parabun, N. Klawach, N. Nic Daeid, P. Kanatharana, and W. Wongniramaikul, "Real time quantitative colourimetric test for methamphetamine detection using digital and mobile phone technology," Forensic Sci. Int., vol. 235, pp. 8-13, Feb. 2014, doi: 10.1016/j.forsciint.2013.11.018.
Analytical Chemistry 2016 By-eye colour interpretation is subjective; smartphone image analysis can provide objective analysis.	App gives POSITIVE / NEGATIVE / NOT SURE	[4] S. T. Krauss et al., "Objective method for presumptive field-testing of illicit drug possession using centrifugal microdevices and smartphone analysis," Anal. Chem., vol. 88, no. 17, pp. 8689-8697, Sep. 2016, doi: 10.1021/acs.analchem.6b01982.
Digital Discovery 2023 Computer vision can quantify and compare colour changes that may look similar by eye.	App shows photo colour next to kit colours	[5] N. Bugeja et al., "Teaching old presumptive tests new digital tricks with computer vision for forensic applications," Digital Discovery, vol. 2, no. 4, pp. 1143-1151, 2023, doi: 10.1039/D3DD00066D.